napkins, surgical and industrial masks, bandages and towels. Semi durable non-woven are used for shirts, curtains, bags, lining material, wicks backing fabrics for picture frames, ribbons, hospital bed linens and operation theatre clothes. (Figure 5.16)

5.7 DIFFERENCE BETWEEN NON-WOVENS AND WOVENS

Difference between Non-Wovens and Wovens

S.No.	Non-wovens	Wovens
1.	Fabrics are made directly from fibres	Fibres are first made to yarns and then inter woven to form fabric
2.	Variations are made by different types of bonding	Variations are made by using different types of yarns and weaving them by different weaves
3.	They are able to spring back into shape after bending or stretching.	They are not as good as non-woven after bending or stretching
4.	They are good in absorbing shocks	They are not good in absorbing shocks
5.	They are easy to shape	They are not easy to shape
6.	They do not ravel	They ravel from both warp and weft direction
7.	The edges need to be finished	The edges need to be finished
8.	They are sound absorbent	They are not sound absorbent
9.	They have good insulation properties which gives warmth	They do not have insulation properties except in cases of worsteds
10.	They will not tear	They will tear
11.	Their breaking load is low	Their breaking load is high
12.	Holes cannot be mended very satisfactorily	Holes can be mended
13.	There is little or no elastic recovery in felt fabrics	They have fairly good elastic recovery
14.	Non-wovens should be washed and ironed carefully and should not be subjected to pulling or twisting	Washing and ironing depends upon fibre, yarn and weave used for construction

5.8 SUMMARY:

Fabric making has been one of the important inventions in the world of textiles. Weaving produce strong fabrics through interlacing of yarns whereas knitting produces flexible fabrics through interloping of yarns. Fibres which are very short with poor spinability can be used for making non-woven fabrics. All these types of methods of fabric production, make a wide range of fabrics to suit all application in day to day life.

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